

Introduction

The American Dream Is Alive and Available

“Chris, do you really think it’s possible for someone like me to become a millionaire?”

I was sitting at a book signing table in a large chain bookstore. It was a cold night in late-January somewhere in the middle of the country, and I was on the last leg of my book tour for my first book, *Retire Inspired*. I’d been on the road for two weeks, meeting all kinds of wonderful people across the country. I talked to people who were doing really well financially, and I talked to people who weren’t. The guy in front of me that night, who we’ll call Chad, definitely wasn’t. I could see it in his eyes: he was beat down, broke, and starting to lose hope that his life would ever be any different than it was at that moment. The thought of actually becoming a millionaire at some point in his life seemed like a fairy tale to him.

“Absolutely,” I said. “Chad, I don’t care who you are, where you’re from, or what hand you’ve been dealt. *Anyone* in this country can become a millionaire.” I’d like to say this guy stood up straight and walked out of that bookstore with a new sense of hope and determination. Although I’ve seen that response many times, it wasn’t in the cards that night. He sighed, took his signed book back from me, and said, “Man, I wish that was true. But it’s not.” With that, he walked out the door just as hopeless and discouraged as he was when he walked in. To be honest, I’m not even sure why he bought my book. I’d like to think that he read it and used it to start building his retirement, but I’ll never know.